

rapidly, so you need a diet rich in DHA. Your body can also store some DHA, so that when you are breast-feeding your baby will continue to receive DHA through your milk—this will help with brain development.

Guidelines vary, but 200 mg of DHA daily is often recommended. This is easily achieved by eating 140 g of baked salmon (around 2 g of DHA) or 140 g grilled mackerel (2.5 g DHA). White fish, such as sea bass and cod, contains much less. If you don't eat fish, consider taking a pregnancy omega-3 supplement. It is possible to buy vegetarian supplements based on algae.

Some studies have demonstrated improved language development, IQ, and cognitive development in babies whose mothers took omega-3 supplements in pregnancy, but more research is needed before routine supplementation in pregnancy can be recommended. Always make sure a supplement is safe in pregnancy and avoid those containing cod liver oil since this is not safe due to high levels of vitamin A.